

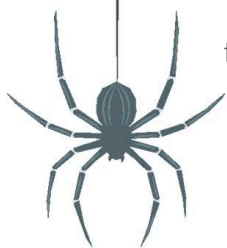
October

15

1952

Charlotte's Web

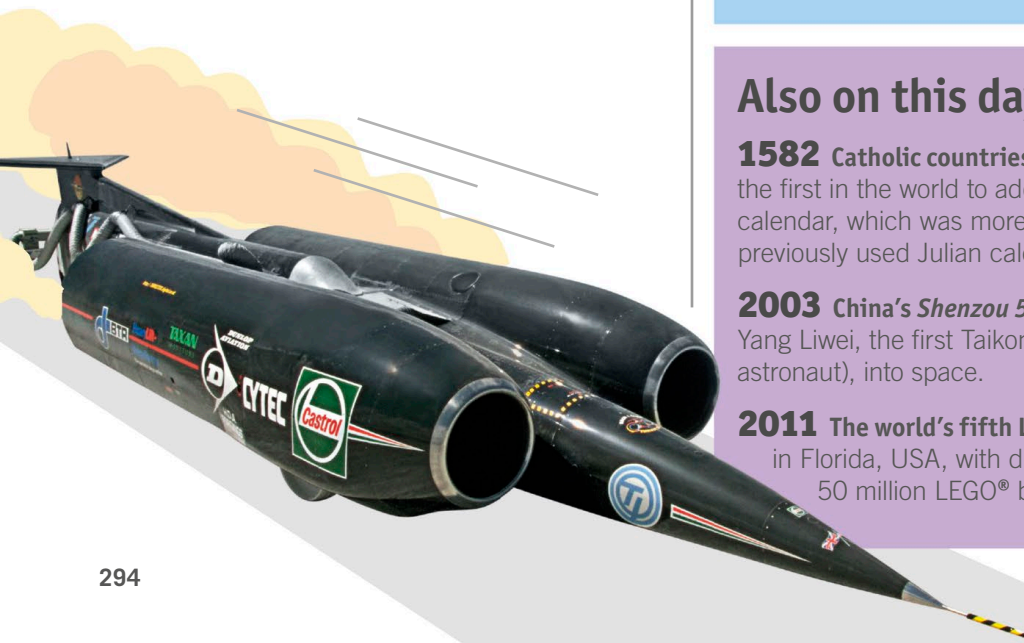
US author E B White's children's book *Charlotte's Web* was published. It tells the story of the friendship between Wilbur the pig and Charlotte, the barn spider. The book went on to sell more than 45 million copies worldwide.



1997

Faster than sound

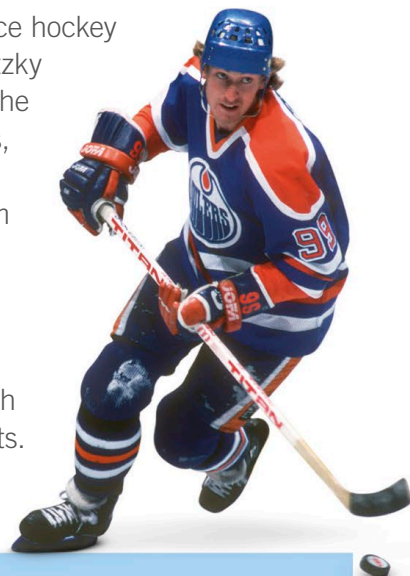
When British driver Andy Green hit a top speed of 1227.9 kph (763 mph) in the *ThrustSuperSonicCar* (*ThrustSSC*) in Nevada's Black Rock Desert in the USA, it became the first land vehicle to break the sound barrier.



1989

Hockey record

In the final moments of a game against the Edmonton Oilers, Canadian ice hockey player Wayne Gretzky scored a goal for the Los Angeles Kings, winning them the game. It made him the all-time top points scorer in North America's National Hockey League (NHL), with 1,851 career points.



Born this day

1938 Fela Kuti, Nigerian musician and composer. He blended American and West African musical influences to invent a new style of music called Afro-beat.

Also on this day

1582 Catholic countries in Europe were the first in the world to adopt the Gregorian calendar, which was more accurate than the previously used Julian calendar.

2003 China's Shenzhou 5 spacecraft carried Yang Liwei, the first Taikonaut (Chinese astronaut), into space.

2011 The world's fifth LEGOLAND® opened in Florida, USA, with displays made up of 50 million LEGO® bricks.